

PMO METHODOLOGY BRIEF

Northgate Financial Group · Enterprise Portfolio

Version 1.0

Issue Date: February 2026

Classification: Internal — PMO Use

PMO Type: Controlling PMO

1 · PMO PURPOSE STATEMENT

The Enterprise PMO provides portfolio governance, delivery controls, and executive reporting to ensure that Northgate Financial Group's investment in change delivers value predictably and with full accountability. The PMO operates as the portfolio's single source of truth — maintaining visibility across all active and pipeline initiatives, enforcing delivery standards, and ensuring that executive decision-making is evidence-based.

2 · PMO TYPE & OPERATING MODEL

PMO Type	Controlling PMO — sets and enforces delivery standards, approves project progression through stage gates, and maintains portfolio-level visibility. Project Managers retain delivery ownership.
Delivery Approach	Hybrid: waterfall governance with Agile sprint execution permitted for product and digital initiatives. All projects must maintain a risk register, issue log, and weekly status update regardless of delivery method.
Scope	All initiatives above \$100K or involving more than 2 business units require PMO registration and stage gate progression. Smaller initiatives are tracked in the Intake Register but may follow a lightweight path.

3 · GOVERNANCE MODEL — PORTFOLIO STEERING COMMITTEE

Members	PMO Director · CFO · CTO · CRO · COO
Frequency	Bi-weekly. Emergency sessions convened by PMO Director with 48-hour notice.
Quorum	3 of 5 members required. CFO or CTO must be present for budget decisions.
Agenda	Portfolio health overview (10 min) · Financial controls (15 min) · Decisions Required (30 min) · AOB (5 min). Total: 60 minutes.
Pack	Distributed 24 hours before the meeting. Three slides: health overview, delivery and financial outlook, decisions required.
Decision Log	All decisions made or deferred are recorded in the Decisions Required log with owner, date, and consequence of delay. Open items carry forward to the next meeting.

4 · REPORTING CYCLE

Weekly	Power BI dashboard refreshed from Excel register. Distributed to PMs and PMO Director by Monday 2:00pm. PMs must submit updates by 12:00pm Monday.
Bi-weekly	Executive Pack (3 slides) distributed to SteerCo 24 hours before meeting.

Monthly	Portfolio health summary to Executive Committee. Dashboard exported to PDF and archived. Monthly automation runs last Friday of the month at 4:00pm.
Ad hoc	Escalation alerts issued within 24 hours of a RAG change to Red or a new SteerCo-flagged escalation.

5 · STAGE GATE DELIVERY MODEL

Gate 0 — Idea Submission	Sponsor identified · Strategic alignment stated · Rough cost estimate provided · Intake form complete.
Gate 1 — Business Case Approval	Cost estimate reviewed by Finance · Sponsor confirmed · Strategic alignment scored · Initial risk register in place. PMO holds project if any criterion not met.
Gate 2 — Project Initiation	PM assigned · Baseline locked · Team confirmed · SteerCo briefed · Resource plan agreed with PMO.
Gate 3 — Go-Live Readiness	UAT signed off · Training complete · Rollback plan approved · Comms distributed · PMO confirms all controls are current.

6 · ESCALATION PATH

Step 1	PM raises issue in weekly status update with RAG, description, and proposed action.
Step 2	PMO Analyst reviews within 24 hours. Classifies as Risk, Issue, Decision, or Overdue Update.
Step 3	If unresolved within 5 business days, PMO Director escalates to relevant executive owner.
Step 4	If a SteerCo decision is required, item is added to the Decisions Required log with options, owner, deadline, and consequence of delay. Tabled at next SteerCo.
KPI	Target: zero escalations open beyond their target resolution date. Reported on Governance page of the Power BI dashboard.

7 · TOOLS & TECHNOLOGY STACK

Jira	Demand intake and project tracking. All intake requests submitted via Jira form. Workflow: Submitted → Under Review → Approved / On Hold / Rejected.
Excel	Project register and capacity model (master data source). Formula-driven KPIs: Schedule Variance, Cost Variance, FAC, RAG Schedule, RAG Cost, RAG Overall, On-Time Delivery Rate. Fixed Report Date Anchor — no TODAY() functions.
Power BI	Portfolio dashboard — 4 pages: Delivery Performance · Financial Controls · Governance & Escalation · Resource & Capacity. Connected to Excel, refreshed weekly.
PowerPoint	Executive Pack — produced bi-weekly. Template-locked. All numbers trace to the Excel register.
Power Automate	Two flows: (1) Weekly PM status reminder — Monday 8:00am. (2) Monthly dashboard PDF export — last Friday of month 4:00pm.
SharePoint	PMO document repository. Stores all artefacts, gate checklists, escalation records, and approved methodology documentation.

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